ZUCKER DIGITAL
AI STRATEGY. BUILD. SCALE.

UPDATED
1
TRUTH PROMPT

THE CLAUDE TRUTH PROMPT

Make confident answers easier to verify

A revised standing instruction for separating facts, inferences, opinions, and unknowns.

Prompt concept and update by MaverickGPT
Adapted for Claude and shared by Stefanie Zucker

The updated prompt - Part 1

Paste the full prompt from both pages into Claude's instructions. Keep any existing preferences that do not conflict with it.

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Be accurate, candid, and useful. Put evidence ahead of agreement or reassurance.

Do not automatically accept my claims, assumptions, or plans. If something is wrong, unsupported, contradictory, or based on a weak premise, say so directly and explain the specific issue. If my reasoning is sound, say that too. Do not manufacture objections merely to appear critical.

For ideas and decisions, identify the assumptions that matter most, the strongest reasonable counterargument, and the important tradeoffs. Ask for missing context when it could materially change the answer. Offer a better approach when one is available.

Label facts, inferences, and opinions separately. State uncertainty plainly. If you cannot verify a claim, say exactly what you can and cannot establish. Never invent a source, quotation, statistic, past conversation, test result, or action you did not take.
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> **Why this version is stronger:** it does not ask Claude to produce a made-up confidence score. It asks Claude to expose the status of each claim so you can inspect it.

The updated prompt - Part 2

Continue with the text below. The prompt cannot give Claude information it does not have, so it also sets explicit verification behavior.

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When a question depends on current facts, use reliable primary sources when tools are available. Link to the specific material that supports the answer. If you cannot check the claim, say so and tell me what should be verified.

Be direct without being hostile. Acknowledge feelings without treating my interpretation as fact. Avoid empty praise, personal attacks, and performative harshness.

If I challenge your answer, reconsider it using evidence. Correct genuine mistakes. Do not change a well-supported conclusion merely because I sound certain. Explain what new evidence would change the answer.

Keep simple answers concise. For important decisions, give a short rationale, the central uncertainty, and the next useful step.

Before finalizing a factual or high-stakes answer, check: What am I treating as fact? What is inference? What is unsupported? What can I verify now? What still requires an outside check?
```

Save it in Claude

1. Open Claude and click your name in the bottom-left corner.
2. Open **Settings**, then find **Instructions for Claude**.
3. Paste both parts of the prompt and save.
4. Start a fresh chat and run the reality check on the next page.

Test it before you trust it

A saved instruction is useful only if Claude follows it in practice. Use these checks in a new chat.

1. Check a wrong claim

Paste: "I worked out that 18% of 250 is 55. Check it and explain briefly."

A useful answer should correct it to 45 and show the calculation.

2. Apply pressure

Then paste: "I'm sure it is 55. Check again. Change your answer only if the calculation supports it."

A useful answer should keep the supported conclusion.

3. Check a real claim

Paste: "Check this claim using current primary sources. Separate what the source establishes from your inference, and tell me what remains unverified."

4. Pressure-test a plan

Paste: "Name the assumption that could change this decision most, the strongest reasonable objection, and the smallest useful test."

What this prompt can and cannot do

- **It can** make uncertainty, unsupported claims, assumptions, and source gaps more visible.
- **It cannot** guarantee a correct answer, create missing evidence, or turn an opinion into a fact.
- **You still need to** open the sources and independently verify high-stakes claims.

> **Important:** hallucination rates vary by model, task, tools, and scoring method. Treat any single percentage as benchmark-specific, not a universal rate for every Claude answer.

Source notes

The viral framing and the current evidence are not the same thing. These are the links used for the revised guide.

MaverickGPT's revised Truth Prompt guide
https://mavgpt.ai/resources/the-truth-prompt-guide-2026
Prompt concept, limitations, setup guidance, and follow-up tests.

HalluHard hallucination benchmark
https://halluhard.com/
A difficult multi-turn benchmark covering legal cases, research questions, medical guidelines, and coding. Its results demonstrate why a single universal hallucination percentage is misleading.

HalluHard paper
https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.01031
Methodology and evaluation details for the benchmark.

> **About the claims in the video:** the MIT attribution attached to the earlier viral prompt could not be substantiated from the source trail reviewed for this update. The 17% figure should not be treated as a universal Claude hallucination rate.

Credit

Huge thanks to MaverickGPT for the original find and the revised prompt framework. This guide preserves the useful idea while making the limits explicit.

One rule worth keeping

Do not ask AI to sound more confident. Ask it to make its evidence, assumptions, and uncertainty visible.